THE JOPETNAH FOUNDATION

Evaluation Policy

Building Whole Communities, One Life at a Time.

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Executive Summary

The Jopetnah Foundation (TJF) is committed to evaluating its programmes, projects and organizational initiatives to improve effectiveness, strengthen accountability and generate evidence for learning.

This Policy establishes the principles, standards and governance arrangements for planning, conducting, managing and using evaluations across the Foundation.

Evaluation is viewed not only as an accountability mechanism, but also as a strategic tool for organizational improvement, innovation and evidence-informed decision-making.

Purpose

This Policy aims to:

- Promote high-quality evaluations.
- Improve programme effectiveness.
- Strengthen organizational accountability.
- Support strategic decision-making.
- Enhance learning and adaptation.
- Meet donor and regulatory requirements.
- Improve transparency with stakeholders.

Scope

This Policy applies to:

- Foundation-wide initiatives.
- Programmes.
- Projects.
- Pilot interventions.
- Strategic partnerships.
- Institutional capacity-building initiatives.
- Major organizational reforms where appropriate.

Guiding Principles

Evaluations conducted by the Foundation shall be:

Independent

Where appropriate, evaluators should be free from conflicts of interest and able to present objective findings.

Ethical

Evaluations shall respect the dignity, rights and privacy of all participants.

Evidence-Based

Conclusions shall be supported by reliable and verifiable evidence.

Participatory

Relevant stakeholders, including beneficiaries where appropriate, should be engaged throughout the evaluation process.

Useful

Recommendations should be practical, realistic and actionable.

Transparent

Evaluation objectives, methods, findings and limitations should be clearly documented.

Types of Evaluation

The Foundation may undertake the following evaluation types.

Baseline Evaluation

Conducted before implementation to establish initial conditions.

Mid-Term Evaluation

Assesses implementation progress and identifies opportunities for improvement.

Final Evaluation

Conducted near the completion of a programme to assess overall performance and achievement of objectives.

Ex-Post Evaluation

Conducted after project completion to assess sustainability and long-term outcomes.

Process Evaluation

Examines how programme activities were implemented.

Outcome Evaluation

Assesses whether intended behavioural, institutional or social changes have occurred.

Impact Evaluation

Examines long-term changes to which the Foundation has contributed, using methods appropriate to the programme context.

Evaluation Criteria

The Foundation aligns its evaluations with widely recognized international evaluation criteria.

Evaluations may assess:

- Relevance
- Effectiveness
- Efficiency
- Coherence
- Sustainability
- Impact

Additional criteria may be included depending on programme objectives.

Evaluation Planning

An evaluation plan should normally define:

- Purpose.
- Scope.
- Evaluation questions.
- Methodology.
- Timeline.
- Budget.
- Roles and responsibilities.
- Reporting requirements.
- Risk considerations.
- Dissemination plan.

Roles and Responsibilities

Board of Trustees

Responsible for:

- Oversight of organizational evaluation.
- Reviewing significant evaluation findings.
- Monitoring implementation of strategic recommendations.

Executive Director

Responsible for:

- Approving major evaluations.
- Ensuring organizational commitment to evaluation.
- Allocating resources.
- Monitoring implementation of management responses.

MEAL Team

Responsible for:

- Coordinating evaluations.
- Developing terms of reference.
- Supporting data collection.
- Managing quality assurance.
- Maintaining evaluation records.
- Facilitating dissemination of findings.

Programme Teams

Responsible for:

- Supporting evaluation activities.
- Providing documentation.
- Facilitating stakeholder engagement.
- Implementing agreed recommendations.

External Evaluators

Where engaged, evaluators are expected to:

- Conduct impartial assessments.
- Apply appropriate methodologies.
- Protect confidential information.
- Deliver reports consistent with agreed terms of reference.
- Disclose any actual or potential conflicts of interest.

Evaluation Methodologies

Depending on programme needs, evaluations may use:

- Surveys.
- Interviews.
- Focus group discussions.

- Observation.
- Document review.
- Administrative data analysis.
- Case studies.
- Comparative analysis.
- Mixed-method approaches.

Methodologies should be appropriate to the evaluation purpose and available resources.

Ethical Standards

All evaluations shall:

- Obtain informed consent where required.
- Protect participant privacy.
- Safeguard vulnerable individuals.
- Respect cultural contexts.
- Avoid causing harm.
- Ensure confidentiality.
- Comply with the Foundation's safeguarding and data protection policies.

Evaluation Reports

Evaluation reports should normally include:

- Executive summary.
- Background.
- Objectives.
- Methodology.
- Findings.
- Conclusions.
- Recommendations.
- Limitations.
- Lessons learned.
- Annexes where applicable.

Reports should distinguish clearly between evidence, analysis and recommendations.

Management Response

Following each major evaluation:

- Management should review recommendations.
- A formal response should be prepared.
- Agreed actions should identify responsible officers and timelines.
- Progress should be monitored and documented.

This process ensures that evaluations contribute to organizational improvement rather than remaining as standalone reports.

Dissemination and Learning

Evaluation findings should be shared appropriately with:

- Staff.
- Board of Trustees.
- Donors.
- Partners.
- Communities, where appropriate.
- Other stakeholders.

Knowledge products such as summaries, presentations or learning briefs may be developed to support wider organizational learning.

Records Management

Evaluation documentation should be retained in accordance with the Foundation's records management procedures.

Records may include:

- Terms of reference.
- Contracts.
- Data collection tools.
- Datasets (subject to privacy requirements).
- Reports.
- Management responses.
- Action tracking logs.

Monitoring Implementation of Recommendations

The MEAL function should maintain a recommendation tracking register that records:

- Recommendation.
- Responsible officer.
- Target completion date.
- Progress status.
- Evidence of completion.

Progress should be reviewed periodically by senior management.

Continuous Improvement

The Foundation will periodically review its evaluation practices by:

- Assessing the quality of completed evaluations.
- Seeking feedback from stakeholders.
- Updating methodologies.
- Investing in staff capacity.
- Aligning with emerging good practice.

Policy Review

This Policy shall be reviewed every three years or sooner if significant organizational, regulatory or donor requirements change.

Evaluation is most valuable when its findings are applied. By learning from evidence and acting on recommendations, The Jopetnah Foundation strengthens its programmes, accountability and long-term impact.